

seduction /si_ˈdɒk_shən/ (1) Temptation to sin, especially temptation to sexual intercourse. (2) Attraction or charm.

- The company began its campaign of seduction of the smaller firm by inviting its top management to a series of weekends at expensive resorts.

Seduction, with its prefix *se-*, “aside,” means basically “lead aside or astray.” In Hawthorne's novel *The Scarlet Letter*, Hester Prynne is forced to wear a large scarlet A, for “adulteress,” after it is revealed that she's been *seduced* by the Reverend Dimmesdale. Seduction also takes less physical forms. Advertisements constantly try to seduce us (often using sex as a temptation) into buying products we hadn't even known existed.

SEQU comes from the Latin verb *sequi*, meaning “to follow.” A *sequel* follows the original novel, film, or television show.

sequential /si.'kwen.shəl/ (1) Arranged in order or in a series. (2) Following in a series.

- In writing the history of the revolution, his challenge was to put all the events of those fateful days in proper sequential order.

Things in *sequence*, or regular order, are arranged *sequentially*. Most novels and films move sequentially, but some use techniques such as flashbacks that interrupt the movement forward in time. Sequential courses in college must follow each other in the proper order, just like sequential tasks or steps.

subsequent /'səb.sɪ.kwənt/ Following in time, order, or place; later.

- Through all her subsequent love affairs, she never stopped thinking about the man who got away.

The prefix *sub-* normally means “below,” and the *sub-* in *subsequent* seems to imply that everything after the first is somehow inferior. As the definition states, *subsequent* can refer to time (“All our subsequent attempts to contact her failed”), order (“The subsequent houses on the list looked even worse”), or place (“The subsequent villages on the river heading east become steadily more primitive”). But *subsequently*, as in “I subsequently learned the real story,” simply means “later.”

consequential /ˌkän.sə.'kwen.shəl/ (1) Resulting. (2) Important.

- None of our discussions thus far has been very consequential; next week's meeting will be the important one.

Something consequential follows or comes along with something else. The “resulting” meaning of *consequential* is usually seen in legal writing. For example, “consequential losses” are losses that supposedly resulted from some improper behavior, about which the lawyer's client is suing. But normally *consequential* means “significant” or “important,” and it's especially used for events that will produce large *consequences*, or results.